

to become a major commercial endeavour was Lycos, which was started at Carnegie Mellon University. Soon, many search engines appeared and vied for popularity. These included WebCrawler, Hotbot, Excite, Inktomi, and AltaVista.

Sites such as Yahoo! initially offered directories instead of search. Later, the directories integrated or added on search engine technology for greater functionality. Before the advent of the Web, there were search engines for other protocols or uses, such as the



With Google ruling the roost MSN and Yahoo are still lagging behind in the search race

Archie search engine for anonymous FTP sites and the Veronica search engine for the Gopher protocol.

Search engines today face a number of hurdles in their effort to index the entire Web. The Web is growing much faster than any present-technology search engine can possibly index. Many Web pages are updated frequently which forces the search engine to revisit them periodically. Dynamically-generated sites may be slow or difficult to index, or may result in excessive results from a single site.